



Little Web Shack



WORDPRESS PLUGIN · USER GUIDE

MBR Cookie Consent

Enterprise-grade consent management for WordPress — global privacy law coverage, server-side blocking, and 40+ language support. Genuinely free.

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1. Introduction

MBR Cookie Consent is a complete, professional-grade consent management platform for WordPress — and it is entirely free. No premium tier, no upsells, no monthly fees, and no third-party branding forced onto your banner.

It was built on a simple frustration: privacy compliance had become something businesses were expected to pay hundreds of pounds a year for, often in exchange for a banner that displayed someone else's logo. This plugin takes the opposite view. Every feature you would expect from an enterprise consent platform is included in the free version, fully documented, and yours to configure however your site needs.

What this plugin does

- Displays a customisable, accessible consent banner that respects the visitor's choices.
- Blocks non-essential scripts and tracking until the visitor gives explicit consent.
- Adjusts automatically to the visitor's region, applying the correct privacy law.
- Integrates with Google Consent Mode v2, Microsoft UET, and IAB TCF v2.3.
- Blocks form submissions server-side until consent is granted — even with JavaScript disabled.
- Keeps an exportable, audit-ready record of every consent interaction.
- Works across single sites and full WordPress Multisite networks.

Good to know

This guide describes version 2.1.0. Because the plugin is distributed directly from littlewebshack.com rather than the WordPress.org repository, you receive updates straight from the developer with no dependency on third-party review queues.

2. Requirements & Compatibility

MBR Cookie Consent is designed to run comfortably on standard WordPress hosting. Before installing, confirm your environment meets the minimums below.

Requirement	Minimum	Recommended
WordPress	6.0	6.5 or newer
PHP	7.4	8.1 or newer
MySQL / MariaDB	5.7 / 10.3	8.0 / 10.6 or newer
HTTPS	Strongly advised	Required for accurate consent records

Tested integrations

- **Page builders:** Elementor, plus the standard WordPress block editor.

- **Form plugins:** Contact Form 7, WPForms, Gravity Forms, Elementor Forms.
- **Multilingual:** WPML and Polylang.
- **Caching:** Compatible with common page caches; see the caching note in Troubleshooting.

Important

If you also run MBR WP Performance or another optimisation plugin that defers or delays JavaScript, read the Troubleshooting section on script ordering before going live. Consent scripts must load early enough to block trackers on the first view.

3. Installation & Activation

Installing the plugin

- Download the latest **mbr-cookie-consent.zip** from littlewebshack.com.
- In your WordPress admin, go to **Plugins** → **Add New** → **Upload Plugin**.
- Choose the downloaded ZIP file and select **Install Now**.
- When installation finishes, select **Activate**.

First activation

On activation the plugin creates its database tables for consent logging and registers a new admin menu, **MBR Cookie Consent**. A default banner configuration is applied immediately so your site is never left without a banner while you finish setting up. You can refine every part of that default in the steps that follow.

Tip

Updating from an earlier version is safe — your settings and consent records are preserved. Always take a routine backup before any plugin update, as you would with any change to a live site.

4. Quick Start: Compliant in Five Minutes

The following sequence gets a typical site to a compliant, working state quickly. Each step is expanded in its own section later in this guide.

Step 1 — Run the cookie scanner

Open **MBR Cookie Consent** → **Scanner** and run a one-click scan. The plugin crawls your pages and lists the scripts and iframes it finds, suggesting a category for each.

Step 2 — Confirm your categories

Review the detected items under Necessary, Analytics, Marketing and Preferences. Adjust any that were placed in the wrong category.

Step 3 — Set your region behaviour

Under **Compliance**, enable geolocation so visitors are shown the banner that matches their jurisdiction (opt-in for the EU and UK, opt-out for much of the US, and so on).

Step 4 — Style the banner

In **Appearance**, set your colours, upload your logo, and choose a layout. The live preview updates as you work.

Step 5 — Publish and test

Save, then visit your site in a private browsing window. Confirm the banner appears, that rejecting consent blocks the relevant scripts, and that the floating revisit button reopens the preferences.

Note

Always test in a private / incognito window. A normal window may already hold a stored consent choice from earlier testing, which hides the banner and makes it look as though nothing is happening.

5. The Consent Banner

The banner is the visitor's first point of contact with your consent settings. It is designed to be clear, fast, and fully accessible.

Banner actions

Action	What it does
Accept All	Grants consent to every category and unblocks all scripts.
Reject All	Declines all non-essential categories; only necessary cookies run.
Customise	Opens the Preference Centre for category-by-category control.

Banner behaviour

- Until a choice is made, all non-essential scripts remain blocked by default.
- The visitor's choice is stored and respected on subsequent visits.
- A floating **revisit button** lets visitors reopen and change their choice at any time.
- Consent can be set to expire after a defined period, prompting re-confirmation.

Important

Equal prominence between Accept and Reject is a requirement under several jurisdictions, including the EU and UK. The default banner gives Accept All and Reject All buttons of equal weight — avoid restyling one to be far more prominent than the other.

6. Banner Customisation

The **Appearance** area lets you make the banner look like a natural part of your site rather than a bolt-on. A live preview reflects each change as you make it.

What you can change

Option	Details
Layout	Choose the banner position and shape — for example a bottom bar, a corner box, or a centred modal.
Colours	Set background, text, button and accent colours to match your brand.
Custom text	Rewrite the banner heading, body copy and button labels in your own voice.
Logo	Upload your own logo to display on the banner and Preference Centre.

Tip

Whatever colours you choose, keep text and buttons at a contrast ratio that meets WCAG 2.1 AA (at least 4.5:1 for normal text). The live preview is a guide to layout, not a substitute for a contrast check.

7. Cookie Categories & the Preference Centre

Cookies and scripts are organised into four standard categories. The Preference Centre is where visitors turn each category on or off individually.

Category	Purpose	Blocked by default?
Necessary	Essential for the site to function; cannot be switched off.	No — always allowed
Analytics	Measurement and statistics, e.g. Google Analytics.	Yes
Marketing	Advertising and cross-site tracking.	Yes
Preferences	Remembering choices such as language or region.	Yes

The Preference Centre

- Each non-necessary category has a clear on/off control.
- A short description explains what each category is for, in plain language.
- Visitors can accept some categories and decline others, then save.
- Choices take effect immediately — scripts in declined categories stay blocked.

8. Cookie Scanner & Script Management

One-click scanning

The scanner crawls your site and detects the scripts and iframes that set cookies or load third-party resources. Each detected item is listed with a suggested category, ready for you to confirm or change.

Manual management

- Add a script or pattern by hand if the scanner cannot reach it (for example, scripts loaded only after login).
- Edit the category or matching rule for any detected item.
- Remove items you no longer use.

Note

Run the scanner again whenever you add a new third-party service — a new analytics tag, chat widget, embedded video, or advertising pixel. Newly added trackers are not blocked until they are known to the plugin.

9. Automatic Script Blocking

This is the engine behind genuine compliance. Rather than simply hiding a banner, the plugin actively prevents non-essential scripts from running until the visitor has given consent for the relevant category.

How it works

- On the first view, scripts in blocked categories are held back and do not execute.
- When the visitor grants consent, the corresponding scripts are released and run normally.
- If consent is declined, those scripts never run, and no cookies they would set are written.
- Necessary scripts are never blocked, so core site functionality is unaffected.

Good to know

Because blocking happens before trackers fire, no analytics or advertising cookies are written ahead of consent. This is the behaviour regulators in the EU and UK expect, and it is the default here rather than an optional extra.

10. Consent Mode Integration

For sites that use Google or Microsoft advertising and analytics, MBR Cookie Consent speaks their consent signalling languages directly, so your tags adjust their behaviour according to the visitor's choices.

Framework	What it covers
Google Consent Mode v2	Signals <code>ad_storage</code> , <code>analytics_storage</code> and the v2 ad-personalisation parameters to Google tags.
Microsoft UET Consent Mode	Passes consent state to the Microsoft Advertising Universal Event Tracking tag.

Framework	What it covers
IAB TCF v2.3	Generates and stores a Transparency & Consent Framework string for IAB-registered vendors.
Google Additional Consent	Supports Google's Additional Consent Mode list alongside the TCF string.

Setting it up

- Enable the relevant framework under **MBR Cookie Consent** → **Consent Mode**.
- Ensure your Google or Microsoft tags load through the plugin's blocking layer so the signals apply.
- Use Google Tag Assistant or the Microsoft UET Tag Helper to confirm the consent state is being received.

Note

Consent Mode changes how tags behave; it does not remove the need for the banner. Keep both enabled — the banner gathers the choice, Consent Mode acts on it.

11. Form Builder Integration

This is the feature that sets MBR Cookie Consent apart. Most plugins block forms with JavaScript alone, which anyone can bypass by disabling JavaScript. This plugin enforces consent on the server.

Server-side enforcement

When a visitor submits a form before granting the required consent, the submission is intercepted on the server and held. Because the check happens server-side, it cannot be circumvented by turning off JavaScript or editing the page.

Supported builders

- Contact Form 7
- WPForms
- Gravity Forms
- Elementor Forms

The Elementor experience

- A clean dark overlay modal replaces inline error messages.
- The visitor is offered **Accept Cookies** or **Not Now**.
- On acceptance, the pending submission is **re-sent automatically** with all entered data intact — the visitor does not have to retype anything.

Configuration

- Choose which consent category a form requires before it will submit.
- Customise the message shown when a submission is blocked.

Tip

The automatic re-submission relies on capturing the original request so it can be replayed after consent. If you use a heavily customised form setup, test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle before launch.

12. Geolocation & Regional Compliance

Different regions demand different consent models. Geolocation lets a single configuration serve the right experience to each visitor automatically.

Model	Typical regions	Banner behaviour
Opt-in	EU / EEA, United Kingdom	Scripts blocked until the visitor actively accepts.
Opt-out	Much of the United States	Scripts may run, with a clear way to opt out / 'Do Not Sell'.
Notice	Regions requiring information only	Visitors are informed; behaviour follows local rules.

- Enable geolocation under **Compliance** to detect the visitor's region.
- The plugin then applies the appropriate model without you maintaining separate banners.
- You can override behaviour for specific regions if your legal advice requires it.

Important

Geolocation tells you where a visitor appears to be; it is not legal advice. If you operate in a regulated sector or are unsure which model applies to you, confirm your obligations with a qualified adviser.

13. Privacy Law Reference

As of May 2026, MBR Cookie Consent is built to help you meet the requirements of the major privacy regimes below. This table is a plain-language summary, not a statement of legal compliance for your specific circumstances.

Law / framework	Region	Consent model
GDPR	EU / EEA	Prior opt-in for non-essential cookies
UK DUAA	United Kingdom	Opt-in, handled separately from EU GDPR
CCPA / CPRA	California, USA	Opt-out, with 'Do Not Sell or Share'

Law / framework	Region	Consent model
US state laws	12 US states	Opt-out, varying by state
India DPDP Act	India	Notice and consent for personal data
Global Privacy Control	Browser-level signal	Honoured automatically as an opt-out

Global Privacy Control (GPC)

GPC is a signal sent by the visitor's browser indicating a blanket opt-out of sale or sharing. The plugin reads this signal and treats it as a valid opt-out where the law recognises it, without the visitor needing to interact with the banner at all.

14. Internationalisation

Automatic translation

The banner and Preference Centre are available in more than 40 languages. The plugin detects the visitor's browser language and serves the matching translation with no configuration required.

Multilingual plugins

- Full string registration for **WPML** and **Polylang**.
- Your custom banner text is translatable through the same workflow as the rest of your site.

Good to know

Version 2.x defers translation loading to the point of use, which resolves the `'_load_textdomain_just_in_time'` notice introduced in WordPress 6.7. If you previously saw that notice, updating clears it.

15. Accessibility

The banner and Preference Centre are built to WCAG 2.1 AA so that consent is genuinely available to every visitor, not just those using a mouse.

- Full keyboard navigation throughout the banner and Preference Centre.
- Screen reader support with appropriate ARIA roles and labels.
- A focus trap keeps keyboard focus within the modal while it is open.
- Visible focus indicators so keyboard users always know where they are.

Tip

If you heavily restyle the banner colours, re-check contrast afterwards. Accessibility is built in, but custom colours are your responsibility to keep within AA contrast ratios.

16. Consent Logging & Records of Consent

Being able to demonstrate consent is as important as collecting it. The plugin keeps a record of every consent interaction.

- Each interaction is logged with its timestamp and the categories chosen.
- IP addresses are anonymised in line with GDPR data-handling expectations.
- Records are exportable to **CSV** for your own audit and retention processes.

Important

Consent records are personal data. Store any exports securely, keep them only as long as you need them, and include them in your own data retention and deletion routines.

17. A/B Testing

A/B testing lets you compare two banner variations to see which earns clearer, higher-quality consent. Define an alternative variant, and the plugin serves the two versions to different visitors so you can compare outcomes.

- Test wording, layout or button styling against each other.
- Compare acceptance behaviour between the two variants.
- Adopt the stronger performer once you have enough data.

Note

Optimise for clarity and informed choice, not for the highest possible Accept rate. A banner engineered purely to maximise acceptance can undermine the validity of the consent you collect.

18. Multisite Support

On a WordPress Multisite network, MBR Cookie Consent is network-aware and adjusts its settings across sites automatically.

- Activate across the network, or per individual site, as you prefer.
- Apply a consistent baseline configuration to every site on the network.
- Allow individual sites to keep their own settings where they differ.
- New sites added to the network pick up the network configuration automatically.

19. CCPA and 'Do Not Sell or Share'

For visitors in California and other US states with similar laws, the plugin can display the required opt-out mechanism.

- An optional **Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information** link is available.
- Selecting it records the visitor's opt-out and applies it to the relevant categories.
- Browser-level Global Privacy Control signals are honoured as a valid opt-out automatically.

20. Troubleshooting & FAQ

The banner does not appear

You have most likely already recorded a consent choice in your current browser. Test in a private / incognito window, or clear the plugin's stored consent for your site, and the banner will return.

Scripts still load before consent

Check that the script is known to the plugin — run the scanner again and confirm it is listed and categorised. Hard-coded scripts placed directly in the theme may need to be added manually. Also confirm no other plugin is loading the script outside the consent layer.

My caching plugin is showing an old banner

After changing banner settings, clear your caches in order: any page-cache plugin first, then your server or host cache, then your browser cache. Stacked caching layers are the most common reason a change does not appear immediately.

Forms submit before consent is given

Confirm the form's required consent category is set under Form Builder Integration, and that the form plugin is one of the supported builders. Then test the full submit-block-accept-resubmit cycle in a private window.

Translations are not showing

Ensure the visitor's browser language is one of the supported languages, and that your custom text has been translated through WPML or Polylang where you use them. Updating to the latest version also clears the WordPress 6.7 text-domain notice.

Does this plugin slow my site down?

The consent layer is lightweight and loads early so it can block trackers on the first view. If you also run a performance plugin that delays JavaScript, make sure the consent script is excluded from delay so it is ready before trackers attempt to fire.

21. Support, Feedback & Resources

Your feedback shapes the plugin. Bug reports are fixed quickly, and the best new features come from real users describing what they need.

Resource	Where
Plugin home	littlewebshack.com/mbr-cookie-consent/
Source & issues	github.com/HarbourBob/MBR-Cookie-Consent

Resource	Where
Email	info@littlewebshack.com
More plugins & dev tools	littlewebshack.com

Whether you have a question, a bug to report, a feature idea, or simply want to say the plugin saved you a subscription — every message is read and valued. Together we are building the best consent manager for WordPress.

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